INCH-POUND

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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

# BEEF STEW, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers beef stew thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

| | |
|---|---|
| PPP-B-636 | - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard |

MILITARY

| | |
|---|---|
| MIL-L-1497 | - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items |
| MIL-L-35078 | - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification for |
| MIL-C-44340 | - Can, Tray Pack |

STANDARDS

MILITARY

| | |
|---|---|
| MIL-STD-105 | - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes |
| MIL-STD-129 | - Marking for Shipment and Storage |
| MIL-STD-900 | - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces |

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20406.)



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U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

Food Safety and Inspection Service, Canning of Meat and Poultry Products (9 CFR Part 318)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications

(Copies are available from the Standardization and Review Branch, Livestock and Seed Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2649, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots

(Copies are available from the Director, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Division, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2077, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies are available from Chairman, Condition of Food Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 0608, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).



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AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 650 California Street, Suite 800, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3330 - Peel Adhesion of Pressure-sensitive Tape

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

AMERICAN SPICE AND TRADE ASSOCIATION (ASTA)

Official Analytical Methods of the American Spice and Trade Association

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Spice and Trade Association, Inc., 580 Sylvan Avenue, Englewood Cliffs, NJ 07632.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)



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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Beef. The beef shall be from steers, heifers, or cows and shall be derived from any combination or portion of recognizable primal rounds (shank-off, heel out, and knuckles, peeled) and sub-primal cuts of the round, shank-off (top round, bottom round (heel out), outside round, and knuckles (peeled)). Recognizable cuts are those which, when compared to Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications (IMPS) cuts, have no more than a minor amount of lean, fat, or bone removed or included from an adjacent cut. A portion is a certified recognizable cut from which objectionable tissue, such as tendons or heavy connective tissue have been removed. The beef shall be in the fresh-chilled state and shall be in excellent condition; for example, exposed lean and fat surfaces shall be of a color and bloom normally associated with the class, grade and cut of meat, and typical of meat which has been properly stored and handled. Cut surfaces and naturally exposed lean surfaces shall show no more than slight darkening or discoloration due to dehydration, aging, or microbial activity. The fat shall show no more than a very slight discoloration due to oxidation or microbial activity. No odors foreign to fresh meat shall be present. Changes in color and odor characteristically associated with vacuum-packaged meat in excellent condition shall be acceptable. Also, the meat shall show no evidence of freezing, defrosting, or mishandling.

3.2.1.1 Boning and trimming. The beef shall be boned and trimmed to remove objectionable material such as bone, cartilage, or heavy connective tissue. The boneless, trimmed beef shall meet the limitations specified in tables I and II.

3.2.1.2 Handling and storage. Handling and storage of the boned and trimmed beef prior to processing into the finished product shall be in accordance with the following requirements:

a. Beef processed on the day of initial certification shall be maintained at an internal temperature of 28° to 50°F (inclusive).

b. Holding in the fresh chilled state for not more than 4 days after initial certification is permitted provided that the beef is maintained at an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F (inclusive).



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c. Holding in the frozen state for not more than 120 days after initial certification is permitted provided that the beef is:

- frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F or lower within 72 hours after initial certification
- stored at 0°F or lower
- protected from freezer deterioration and damage
- stored in containers that are adequate to maintain product excellence.

d. Tempering/thawing of frozen beef shall comply with the following:

- microwave tempering/thawing of frozen beef is permitted provided excellent condition of the beef, as determined by USDA, is maintained
- the microwave tempering/thawing process shall not exceed 24 hours from time of removal of the beef from the freezer to further preparation
- regardless of the process used, frozen beef shall be tempered/thawed to a temperature not to exceed 40°F
- when a tempering/thawing process other than microwave is used, the time from the start of the tempering/thawing process (removal from freezer) to further preparation shall not exceed 96 hours
- beef which has been tempered/thawed shall not be refrozen.

3.2.1.3 Beef, dried, individually quick frozen. The beef dices shall be prepared from fresh chilled beef that complies with 3.2.1, 3.2.1.1 and 3.2.1.2a and b. The beef shall be further trimmed if necessary, so as to ensure compliance with finished product requirements (see 3.6). The beef shall be cut or diced into chunks approximately 1 by 1 by 1 inch. The individually quick frozen dices shall be screened to eliminate fines. After screening, the individually quick frozen dices shall be packaged and vacuum sealed in water-impermeable material having an oxygen impermeability rate of not more than 10 cubic centimeters of oxygen per square meter per 24 hours of 73°F and 0 percent relative humidity. The initial freezing (in-storage) date and processing and packaging requirements shall be certified by a USDA Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) Livestock Division Agent. The packaged, frozen beef dices shall have been held at an internal temperature of 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 120 days prior to further processing (see 3.3.1c and d). The individually quick frozen dices shall be tempered/thawed in accordance with 3.2.1.2d.

3.2.2 Water. Water used for ice making, formulation, rehydration, blanching, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.



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3.2.3 Peas, green.

3.2.3.1 Peas, green, fresh. The peas shall be fresh, sound, clean, sweet green peas of a variety suitable for canning. The shelled peas shall be well-formed, bright, young, tender, and of such size as not to pass through a 9/32-inch sieve.

3.2.3.2 Peas, green, frozen. Frozen green peas shall be U.S. Grade A in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas and shall be of the latest season's crop.

3.2.4 Potatoes.

3.2.4.1 Potatoes, fresh. The potatoes shall be fresh, firm, clean, sound, and of a white flesh variety suitable for canning. The maximum specific gravity for the potatoes shall be 1.075 with a reducing sugar content of not more than 2.0 percent on a dry weight basis.

3.2.4.2 Potatoes, dehydrofrozen, diced. The diced, dehydrofrozen potatoes shall be firm, possess a good color and flavor, and be of a white flesh variety suitable for canning. The maximum specific gravity for the potatoes shall be 1.075 with a reducing sugar content of not more than 2.0 percent on a dry weight basis. The potatoes shall be of the latest season's pack. Dice size shall be approximately 1 by 1 by 1/2 inch in dimension.

3.2.5 Carrots.

3.2.5.1 Carrots, fresh. The carrots shall be fresh, firm, of good color, and of a variety suitable for canning.

3.2.5.2 Carrots, frozen, cross cut slices. The frozen carrots shall be U.S. Grade A in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots. The carrots shall be cross cut slices of 1/4 to 3/8 inch by 7/8 to 1-1/4 inch and shall be of the latest season's pack.

3.2.6 Starch, modified, high opacity. The high opacity starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified maize food starch for use in thermostabilized foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140° to 170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. The modified starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress, and under conditions of cold storage. The cooked modified starch slurry shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.7 Onions, dehydrated, chopped. Chopped, dehydrated onions shall be fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.



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3.2.8 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined, sodium chloride, with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.9 Sugar. Sugar shall be refined, sucrose, liquid or granulated, cane or beet sugar, or both, and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.10 Onion powder. Onion powder shall be fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.11 Lecithin. Lecithin shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.12 Vegetable protein, hydrolyzed (HVP). The hydrolyzed vegetable protein shall have been obtained by the hydrolysis of any one or any combination of corn, soybean, or wheat proteins from which none of the monosodium glutamate has been extracted during processing. The product shall possess a characteristic color and flavor. Salt (chloride calculated as NaCl) shall not exceed 35 percent. The pH of a 2-percent solution shall not be less than 4.3 nor greater than 7.0. Hydrolyzed protein shall be soluble in water at 90°F to the extent of not less than 5 grams in 100 milliliters.

3.2.13 Paprika, ground. Paprika shall be Spanish paprika (Capsicum annuum L.) and shall possess a bright orange to red color with an extractable color value of not less than 110 American Spice and Trade Association color units. The ground paprika shall be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 30 sieve.

3.2.14 Celery, soluble. Soluble celery flavoring shall be prepared by properly blending and dispersing a minimum of 4 percent by weight of total extractives of the dried fruit of Apium graveolens L. on a soluble, dry, edible carrier. The flavoring shall possess a clean, celery-like aroma with a slightly bitter taste. It shall be free flowing, be free from caking, and be yellowish-grey in color.

3.2.15 Pepper, black, ground. The ground black pepper shall have been ground from the deep brown to black, deep-set, wrinkled, immature berries of Piper nigrum L. The ground pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot biting pungent flavor and a light grey to speckled black-grey color. The ground black pepper shall contain not less than 2.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground black pepper and shall be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 16 sieve.

3.2.16 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this specification. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.



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3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Beef preparation. The beef shall be prepared as follows:

a. Boned and trimmed beef meeting the requirements of 3.2.1.1 shall be further trimmed, if necessary, to assure compliance with finished product requirements.

b. The beef shall be cut or diced into chunks approximately 1 inch by 1 inch by 1 inch.

c. The beef chunks shall be heated in water until no raw portions are visible, drained, and the broth retained for use in gravy preparation.

d. The cooked beef chunks shall be cooled to an internal temperature of 28° to 40°F as rapidly as possible and held in this temperature range for not more than 24 hours prior to filling into tray pack cans.

3.3.2 Potato preparation.

3.3.2.1 Fresh potato preparation. The clean, fresh potatoes shall be peeled, trimmed, and mechanically diced with dicer settings of 1 by 1 by 1/2 inch dimensions. The diced potatoes shall be blanched sufficiently to prevent discoloration and to remove excess air. The blanched potatoes shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled, drained potato dices shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration and filled into tray pack cans within 4 hours after blanching.

3.3.2.2 Diced, dehydrofrozen potato preparation. Diced, dehydrofrozen potatoes shall be prepared in a manner to assure compliance with finished product requirements and shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration.

3.3.3 Carrot preparation.

3.3.3.1 Fresh carrot preparation. The clean, fresh carrots shall be peeled, trimmed and cut into 1/4 to 3/8 by 7/8 to 1-1/4 inch cross cut slices. The sliced carrots shall be blanched sufficiently to prevent discoloration and to remove excess air. The blanched carrots shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled, drained carrot slices shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration and filled into tray pack cans within 4 hours after blanching.

3.3.3.2 Frozen carrot preparation. Frozen carrots shall be prepared in a manner to assure compliance with finished product requirements and shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration.



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3.3.4 Gravy preparation. The gravy shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

| Ingredients | Percent by weight |
|---|---|
| Water and broth | 82.52 |
| Peas, green | 8.00 |
| Starch, modified, high opacity | 5.25 |
| Onions, chopped, dehydrated | 1.27 |
| Salt 1/ | 1.50 |
| Sugar | 0.50 |
| Onion powder | 0.27 |
| Lecithin | 0.25 |
| HVP | 0.20 |
| Paprika | 0.10 |
| Celery, soluble | 0.08 |
| Pepper, black, ground | 0.06 |

1/ The total amount of salt in the gravy formula shall be adjusted as necessary to produce a product that complies with the finished product salt requirements (see 3.6).

NOTE: The following gravy preparation procedures were used in the development of this product. Alternative procedures may be used provided finished product requirements are met. (When alternative procedures are used, the time and temperature requirements specified for the prepared gravy are still applicable.)

a. A slurry shall be made with the starch and part of the water. The remaining ingredients shall be mixed together and heated to not less than 140°F. The starch slurry shall be added and the final mixture heated to a temperature of 180° to 190°F, and held for approximately 5 minutes.

b. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

c. The gravy shall be maintained in the temperature range of 150° to 180°F for not more than 4 hours prior to filling into tray pack cans.

3.3.5 Product preparation. The product shall be prepared from component ingredients in the following proportions:

| Ingredients | Percent by weight |
|---|---|
| Beef | 39.62 |
| Gravy | 35.76 |
| Potatoes | 16.36 |
| Carrots | 8.26 |



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3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum established by a processing authority and specified in the scheduled process so as to ensure compliance with the finished product requirements (see 3.6v).

b. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after sealing.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value ($F_o$) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, in a can shall be not more than 2 ounces.

e. No individual can shall contain a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.

f. Surface fat on each beef chunk shall measure not more than 1/8 inch in thickness.

g. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

h. No individual can shall have a net weight of less than 104 ounces.

i. No individual can shall contain less than 29.0 ounces of drained intact beef chunks.

j. The average drained weight of beef shall be not less than 33.0 ounces.

k. No individual can shall contain less than 23.0 ounces of drained vegetables (combined).



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l. The average drained weight of vegetables (combined) shall be not less than 27.0 ounces.

m. Beef texture shall not be dry, mushy, rubbery, or tough.

n. Vegetable texture shall not be mushy, hard, fibrous, or tough.

o. At least 75 percent (by weight) of the beef shall be discernible beef chunks.

p. The gravy shall not be lumpy.

q. The viscosity of the gravy shall be not less than 13.0 cm per 10 seconds nor greater than 22.0 cm per 10 seconds when determined by a Bostwick Consistometer.

r. The average fat content of the finished product shall be not greater than 9.0 percent.

s. No individual tray pack shall have a fat content greater than 11.0 percent.

t. No individual tray pack shall have a salt content less than 1.0 percent or greater than 1.5 percent.

u. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

v. Filled, sealed, and retorted cans shall show evidence of proper vacuum as determined by concavity of the can lid (see 4.5.6).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The meat component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.



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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4)
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5)

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Beef examination for condition and cut. All beef shall be examined in either the bone-in or boneless state for conformance to the condition and cut requirements in 3.2.1. Cuts initially examined in the boneless state shall be in the form of whole boneless recognizable cuts or portions thereof. Any nonconforming beef shall be rejected.

4.5.1.2 Boned and trimmed beef examination. After boning and trimming and prior to any further processing or to any freezing, the beef shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size expressed in terms of pounds shall be declared to the Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agent by the contractor. However, the AMS agent reserves the right to declare as a lot a portion of a declared lot, if, in his or her opinion, that portion may be out of compliance with any requirement. The sample unit shall be a minimum of 12 pounds of adjacent boneless beef. The sample size shall be as specified in table I. If all or a portion of the sample unit falls within a larger cut, the entire cut shall be examined. Failure of the beef to meet the acceptance criteria as indicated in table I shall be cause for rejection of the lot.



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Except for beef rejected because of freezing, defrosting, or not being in excellent condition, the beef may be reworked by the contractor and reoffered for examination. For reexamination, the sampling plan used shall be the one in table I designed for the next larger lot size than the one under which the lot was initially rejected. Beef shall not be reexamined more than one time.

TABLE I. Sampling plan for boned and trimmed beef

| Lot size (pounds) | Sample size (No. of sample units) | Defect categories | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | | Minor | |
| | | AC | RE | AC | RE |
| 500 or less | 20 | 2 | 3 | 5 | 6 |
| 501 to 1200 | 32 | 3 | 4 | 7 | 8 |
| 1201 to 3200 | 50 | 5 | 6 | 10 | 11 |
| 3201 to 10000 | 80 | 7 | 8 | 14 | 15 |
| 10001 to 38000 | 125 | 10 | 11 | 21 | 22 |
| Reinspection lots of 10001 to 38000 | 200 | 14 | 15 | 21 | 22 |

TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects 1/ 2/

| Category | | Defect |
|---|---|---|
| Major | Minor | |
| 101 | | Presence of popliteal, prescapular, prefemoral, or any exposed lymph gland measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension. |
| 102 | | Presence of blood clot measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension. |
| | 201 | Presence of blood clot measuring 0.5 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in any dimension. |
| 103 | | Presence of bruise measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension. |



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TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

| Category | | Defect |
|---|---|---|
| Major | Minor | |
| | 202 | Presence of bruise measuring 0.5 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in any dimension. |
| 104 | | Presence of bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension. |
| 105 | | Presence of cartilage measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension. |
| 106 | | Presence of backstrap measuring 1.0 inch or more in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other). |
| | 203 | Presence of backstrap measuring 0.5 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other). |
| 107 | | Presence of heavy connective tissue (for example, on the surface of the outside round adjacent to the knuckle, along the skin surface of the strip loin, or gracilis membrane) measuring 2.0 square inches or more. |
| | 204 | Presence of heavy connective tissue (for example, on the surface of the outside round adjacent to the knuckle, along the skin surface of the strip loin, or gracilis membrane) measuring 0.5 square inches or more but less than 2.0 square inches. |
| | 205 | Presence of heavy connective tissue on lower edge of short plate or flank. |
| | 206 | Presence of heavy connective (abdominal tunic) tissue on the flank measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension. |
| | 207 | Presence of membranous portion of diaphragm or membranous covering from skirt, flank, or abdominal section of short plate measuring 3.0 square inches or more. |



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TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

| Category | | Defect |
|---|---|---|
| Major | Minor | |
| 108 | | Presence of knuckle cover. |
| 109 | | Presence of kidney, pizzle eye, prepubic tendon, thymus gland, or hanging tender measuring 1.0 inch or more in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other). |
| | 208 | Presence of kidney, pizzle eye, prepubic tendon, thymus gland, or hanging tender measuring less than 1.0 inch in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other). |
| | 209 | Presence of calcified (scratchy) periosteum measuring 2.0 square inches or more. |
| | 210 | Presence of shank, clod, knuckle, or bottom (outside) round with tendinous end showing less than 75 percent lean tissue on a cross-sectional cut surface. |
| | 211 | Presence of dehydrated surface measuring 1.0 square inch or more. |
| | 212 | Presence of discolored meat (including blood discolored neck meat) measuring 1.0 square inch or more. |
| | 213 | Presence of exposed blood vessel measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension. |
| | 214 | Presence of cod, udder, kidney, or pelvic fat. |

1/ Determination of wholesomeness and acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (for example: glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal) shall be determined by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee.

2/ Evidence of freezing or defrosting or product not in excellent condition shall cause rejection of the involved lot.



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4.5.1.3 *Ingredient and component examination*. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.5.3.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.3.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table III. The tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be heated in accordance with heating instructions on the can label, opened, and inspected for the defects listed in table IV.



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TABLE III. Double sampling plan for product inspection. 1/

| Lot size (cans) | Sample size (cans) | Cumulative sample | Acceptance number | Rejection number |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 to 3200 | 8 | - | 0 | 2 |
| | 8 | 16 | 1 | 2 |
| 3201 to 35000 | 13 | - | 0 | 3 |
| | 13 | 26 | 3 | 4 |

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE IV. Product defects 1/ 2/

| Category | Defect |
|---|---|
| Major | |
| 101 | Total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, in a can is more than 2 ounces. |
| 102 | Presence of bone piece 0.3 inch or more in any dimension in an individual can. |
| 103 | Surface fat on beef chunk measuring more than 1/8 inch in thickness. |
| 104 | Drained weight of intact beef chunks in a can is less than 29.0 ounces. 3/ 4/ |
| 105 | Drained weight of vegetables (combined) in a can is less than 23.0 ounces. 3/ 5/ |



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TABLE IV. Product defects 1/ 2/

| Category | Defect |
|---|---|
| Major | |
| 106 | Less than 75 percent (by weight) of the beef consists of discernible beef chunks. 6/ |
| 107 | Beef texture dry, tough, rubbery, or mushy. |
| 108 | Vegetable texture mushy, hard, fibrous, or tough. |
| 109 | Gravy consistency is lumpy or is excessively thick or thin. |
| 110 | Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched). |

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example, glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ To determine drained weight, the free liquid in the can shall be poured off, strained through a U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve, and reserved for viscosity determinations. The remaining contents of the can shall be poured into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 190° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be agitated so as to liquify rendered fat and remove gravy without breaking the beef chunks. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/4 inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the beef chunks. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at approximately a 45° angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight of the beef and vegetables shall be determined individually and shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4/ Lot shall be rejected if the sample average drained weight of beef is less than 33.0 ounces.



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Instrument: Bostwick Consistometer
Catalog Number: 23270-004
VWR Scientific Company
P.O. Box 7900
San Francisco, CA 94120

or

Catalog Number: 15-347-50
Fisher Scientific
585 Alpha Drive
Pittsburgh, PA 15238

Method:

a. Level the instrument.

b. Bring gravy to 100° ± 1°F in a water bath in a covered container.

c. Stir gravy thoroughly before filling the Bostwick cavity.

d. Scrape gravy evenly across upper edge of cavity.

e. Release gravy and time gravy flow to the nearest 1 second and measure distance traveled to the nearest 0.1 cm.

The lot shall be rejected if the Bostwick viscosity value of the gravy from any can in the sample is less than 13.0 cm per 10 seconds or greater than 22.0 cm per 10 seconds.

4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with 4.5.4.1. In addition, the following defect shall be classified as a critical defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot:

Bare metal exposed on exterior of can (see 5.1.1).

4.5.4.1 Can label examination. Labels shall be examined for defects in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4), except, for self-adhering labels, the following additional defects shall apply:

Major: Label torn or scratched so as to obliterate any of the markings.

Minor: Air bubbles under label.
Label not properly adhered to can, for example, label raised or peeled back from edges or corners.



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5.1.1 Level A. One hundred and six ounces of food product shall be filled into a tray pack can conforming to MIL-C-44340 and sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. There shall be no evidence of denting, scuffing, scratching or abrasion of exterior can coating resulting in exposure of bare metal (see 4.5.4).

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L or HSC-L with an HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1) except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load



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with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and with the following:

- Official establishment number (for example, EST 38) or a three digit letter code identifying the establishment.
- Lot number 1/
- Production shift number 1/
- Retort identification number 1/
- Retort cook number 1/

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year (Example, March 19, 1987 would be coded as 7078). The Julian code shall represent the day the product was packaged and processed. Sub-lotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four digit Julian code. Following the four digit Julian code and the alpha character (when used), the other required code information shall be printed in the sequence as listed above.

In addition, the name of product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.5.4 after preparation of product in accordance with heating instructions. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT IN WATER: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 40 - 45 minutes. Avoid overheating (can shows evidence of bulging).

CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

TO HEAT IN OVEN: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place. Place in a 350°F oven 35 - 40 minutes.

WARNING: Do not place unopened can in oven. This may cause the can to burst.

YIELD: Serves 12 portions of 1 cup each.



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As an alternative labeling method, a preprinted, self-adhering, 0.002-inch thick, clear polyester label printed with indelible black ink may be used. Self-adhering labels shall be applied after retorting. Pressure-sensitive adhesive shall require no preparation prior to application. Labels shall tack quickly and adhere without curling or breaking. The adhesive shall have a minimum adhesion of 60 ounces per inch width when examined as specified in 4.5.4.2. When self-adhering label is used, the tray pack can shall be labeled with the Julian code and a product code prior to retorting.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary marking in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE, UNLESS PALLET RACKS ARE USED.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).
e. Level of packing required (see 5.2).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.



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6.3 Appropriate level of pack. Based on conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.4 Alternative viscosity testing method. The contracting officer may authorize an alternative contractor recommended method of viscosity testing if the alternative method is approved by U.S. Army Natick, Research, Development, and Engineering Center.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned food
Combat field feeding
Food processing
Operational rations
Shelf stable

6.6 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC
DP - SS

Preparing Activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8940-0673)



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# STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

*(See Instructions – Reverse Side)*

| 1. DOCUMENT NUMBER | 2. DOCUMENT TITLE |
|---|---|
| MIL-B-44294A | BEEF STEW, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK |

| 3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION | 4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)* |
|---|---|
| | ☐ VENDOR<br>☐ USER<br>☐ MANUFACTURER<br>☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____ |
| b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* | |

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

| 7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional | b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional |
|---|---|
| c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional | 8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)* |

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